

Directions: Answer the following questions in complete sentences and in a professional manner (use question/answer format).

The following questions come from www.counseling.org Links to an external site.

1. What is ACA? Describe its role as an organization?
 - a. ACA stands for American Counseling Association. Its role as an organization is to provide education, community and professional development opportunities. It's an organization dedicated to the growth of the counseling profession.
2. Examine the divisions of ACA. Which ones strike your interest?
 - a. There are several divisions of ACA that strike my interest. The one that stood out the most for me was the American Rehabilitation Counseling Association (ARCA). This organization is involved with counselors who are concerned with enhancing the development of people with disabilities through therapy and research.
3. Where will the ACA conference be this coming year?
 - a. The ACA Annual Conference will be in Orlando, Florida.
4. Browse the site. What information is there for graduate students? Other things of interest?
 - a. While browsing the site I looked into the advocacy tab and the counseling compact act was there. I found it very interesting that there are toolkits for people to become aware of some ways to advocate for the bill to pass.

The following questions come from <https://txca.org/> Links to an external site.

5. What is TCA? Describe the function of the organization.
 - a. TCA stands for Texas Counseling Association. The function of the organization is to focus on promoting high professional standards and to increase access to professional counselors across Texas.
6. Where and when is the next annual TCA conference?
 - a. The next annual TCA conference will take place from October 30th to November 1st in Dallas, Texas.

Answer these based on your personal experiences.

7. How would you define professional counseling?
 - a. Professional counseling is being competent in the field pursuing the requirements needed to become a licensed counselor. A professional counselor is also someone who has their own identity while empowering clients' own identities to help them cope with their mental health in an effective way.

8. How do you describe the identity and responsibilities of a mental health counselor?
 - a. The identity of a mental health counselor is to be authentic and passionate about their career among other qualities that will help the patient thrive. There are many responsibilities of being a mental health counselor with the main ones being to encourage clients to express their feelings, maintain confidentiality records, and ensure a safe place for the clients.
9. What attracts you to the field of clinical mental health counseling?
 - a. Being a licensed professional mental health counselor is a goal I have aspired to throughout my life before I knew what it implied. I always knew I wanted to work in a setting where I would feel rewarded and with a purpose. Having a sibling with down syndrome magnified that desire of having a purpose in life and being able to empower the people around me.
10. What population are you interested in serving once you are licensed and why?
 - a. The population I am interested in serving once I am licensed are children with down syndrome and/or families who are a guardian to children with special needs. The reason for the population I am interested in serving is my family and experiencing difficult times we endured because we did not have the resources to overcome having a family member who had a disability.
11. What or who has influenced your decision to become a professional counselor (significant people, experiences, events, etc.)
 - a. My sister with special needs was my inspiration but when I started working with children on the spectrum providing ABA therapy I realized I was also interested in providing therapy to their family members.
12. What strengths do you believe you already possess that will help you in this field?
 - a. The strengths I believe I possess that will help me in this field are empathy, compassion, patience but most importantly I believe acceptance of differences is my biggest attribute.
13. What skills do you hope to gain in this program?
 - a. The skills I hope to gain in this program is being able to confidently voice my concerns and being an effective counselor with great qualities that will help my patient succeed in goals they are trying to achieve.
14. What are some areas of growth you want/need to invest in to be able to help others?
 - a. Some areas I need to grow on and need to invest in to be able to help others is helping myself by attending therapy to heal my own personal wounds. My clients will only be able to go as far as I am. providing

effective therapy to them will need to start by acknowledging my own wounds.

15. What are your thoughts on how people change?

- a. My thoughts on how people change do not have a straight line. Nobody is perfect and nobody can change from one day to another. Change comes in different ways for everybody whether it's starting small or making a huge change in your life. Change comes within time by experiencing life and going to therapy to cope with changes is a great start to a positive outlook in life.

16. What are some social justice issues that you are passionate about that you may want to advocate for in the future?

A social justice issue in counseling I am passionate about and would want to advocate in the future is representation and inclusion. A population I am interested in advocating is hispanics with children with a disability such as down syndrome or autism.

17. What is your vision for your future career?

- a. My vision for my future career is providing services to families and children with special needs. I would like to start working at a hospital out of graduate school and after years of supervision and experience I hope to open my private practice and become an advocate for children.